

ical companies. They didn't restrict themselves to single ethical issues, such as birth control or alcohol, but rather sought out investments that were ethical overall. This brought us full-circle from the Middle Ages, when ethical investing was oxymoronic.

Most everyone who started out drawing the line somewhere—at nuclear power, cigarettes, women's rights, or the military—ended up drawing several lines at once. With so much damning information on so many companies, and so many companies becoming conglomerates, it was no simple task to find a likable investment. A few mutual funds began to specialize in ethical selections. Three of the biggest as of this writing were: Pax World Fund of Portsmouth, New Hampshire (no liquor, tobacco, gambling, or weapons-systems stocks), the Calvert Fund of Washington, D.C. (no alcohol, tobacco, nuclear energy, weapons systems, companies doing business in South Africa, environmental scofflaws, or enemies of unions), and the Pioneer Group of Boston (no alcohol, tobacco, or South Africa).

Ethical money-managers began to offer professionally chosen, socially screened accounts. There were socially conscious money-market funds, such as one managed by the Calvert group, which avoided the contamination of U.S. Treasury bills. Instead, its capital floated around with Freddie Mac, Fannie Mae, small business loans, cogeneration, office equipment, hydropower, regional banking, and natural gas. There were socially-conscious investment newsletters, including *The Clean Yield* and *Good Money*, both published in Vermont.

Many who began to invest in this systematically ethical way also found themselves wanting to ethically consume. People who began with good intentions soon had no place to put their money, and nothing to eat or drink. On that score, you'll never catch me buying Chilean grapes or plums. My wife won't buy German cars. My friend Phil Stanford says somebody told him not to drink Portuguese wine, but he can't remember why. After the movie *Z* came out, we vowed never to drink ouzo again. Actually, we never drank ouzo in the first place. I gave up nonunion lettuce—which fortunately happened to be iceberg—just at the time it became fashionable to upgrade to endive.

So in my own haphazard way, I was an ethical investor and also